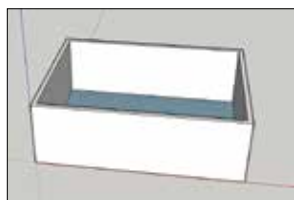


USING SKETCH UP TOOLS TO CREATE A SIMPLE OBJECT

Let's get started with the tutorial to make a simple house on Sketchup for Web.

- Create a simple rectangle using the rectangle tool in the toolbar.
- Next, use the offset tool to create a border on the



Use the offset tool to create a wall by offsetting an inner rectangle from the original one. Then use the push-pull tool to make the walls to 3D.

inside of the rectangle. This will act as the walls.

- Now, to get some real 3D action going on, use the push/pull tool to extend your walls by clicking and dragging the border you have created.
- Next, create rectangles and squares for your doors and windows. You can also search for premade entities like windows and walls in the 'Components' panel on the right side.



- Once you're done with that, fire up the push/pull tool again to cut holes in the walls where your doors and windows are. Just select the entity and pull it towards the center of the top of the wall, as shown in the picture above.

- You should now have 3D cut-outs for door and windows.
- Use the line tool to create a triangle on top of any side of the house to make the roof.
- Once you have created a triangle, use the push/pull tool to extend it all the way to the other side.
- Use the 'Materials' panel to add colour to your house as per your choice.
- There you have it! You have successfully built a simple (very simple) house. Pat yourself on the back and now get to creating something a little more challenging.

Once you play around with all these tools you will be able to create simple 3D shapes and even objects



Go ahead and start creating objects like this simple house we managed to create.

such as houses, automobiles and even faces. We recommend a graphic tablet and the free hand tool for those who are proficient at free-style drawing.

SKETCHUP PANELS

Sketchup for web has an array of icons on the right side of the screen which opens up the corresponding panel when a panel icon is clicked. You can also click the panel name to toggle it open or close it, as per your requirement. Let's learn more about each panel.

Entity info

You can check the specific details about your enti-



The Entity Info can be brought up by clicking on the top-left icon on the toolbar on the right.

ties by selecting an entity/shape and clicking on the Entity Info icon. The entity info gives you details like layer information, shadows settings and entity visibility. You can also view the type of entity it is and edit your definition of the object. This allows users to see the square feet area of the entity (if you have chosen the feet and inches template, other templates will show area information accordingly). This tool is extremely important to people who are attempting to 3D print their model and professionals such as architects or interior decorators.

Instructor

The instructor panel is a nifty little addition that provides additional information on what a particular tool does, and how best to use it. This is your go to panel if you are just starting up on Sketchup, or want to do more with the different tools available.

Components

The Sketchup components panel can be used to search for premade components of common objects. For example, numerous users have already made houses on Sketchup that have doors and windows. You can avoid the hassle of making them yourself and utilise a premade component of the object you require by searching for it in this panel.

Materials

The Materials panel lets you add colour, texture and photographs to your 3D model. With this panel you can enhance your 3D model by adding textures and materials to make your model seem more realistic. You can add grass, tile, carpet, wood, glass, and many more real-life textures. Photographs can be pinned to your 3D model as well. You can find premade colours and textures in this panel, you



The texture makes the previously cartoon-ish looking house more realistic.

can also create your own by mixing and matching the materials from those available.

There are a few more panels on Sketchup web like:

- Style which let's control a bunch of textural nuances of your model
- Layers lets you control the visibility of different layers.
- Views allows you to choose different perspectives to look at your model from.
- Display lets you manage hidden objects, section planes, section cuts, axes and guides.

You can now begin your journey towards creating a 3D model and making your imagination come into fruition. Sketchup web gives you a plethora of tools to help you customise your 3D object and craft it exactly according to your intention. Go ahead and experiment with Sketchup web and begin creating your own 3D models. Send us in your creations to editor@digit.in. 